UNIT 1: BEGINNING YOUR JOURNEY, CAREER READINESS ORIENTATION

TOPIC 9: MOVING FORWARD

Topic OBJECTIVES: The learner will:

- Understand the importance of coping strategies for overcoming obstacles and maintaining a positive attitude
- Understand what resiliency means
- Feel acknowledged and recognized for his/her hard work throughout training

Topic OUTCOMES: The learner will:

- Identify current coping skills as well as new coping skills they want to try
- Write a letter to herself/himself acknowledging what he/she has accomplished and learned in the training
- Help others identify strategies for challenges

Topic ACTIVITIES:

I. Welcome to the Day

Opening Questions:

- What was your favorite part of the training?
- What was the most important thing you learned (in general or about yourself)?

Opening Quotes:

- "The farther backward you can look, the farther forward you can see."
  ~ *Winston Churchill* (British prime minister)
- "March on. Do not tarry. To go forward is to move toward perfection. March on, and fear not the thorns, or the sharp stones on life's path."
  ~ *Kahlil Gibran* (artist, poet and writer)
- "Develop an attitude of gratitude, and give thanks for everything that happens to you, knowing that every step forward is a step toward achieving something bigger and better than your current situation."
  ~ *Brian Tracy* (self-help author)
- "Don't dwell on what went wrong. Instead, focus on what to do next. Spend your energies on moving forward toward finding the answer."
  ~ *Denis Waitley* (author, keynote speaker and productivity consultant)
- "Life is like riding a bicycle. To keep your balance, you must keep moving."
  ~ *Albert Einstein* (physicist, philosopher and author)
- "All of the top achievers I know are life-long learners… looking for new skills, insights, and ideas. If they're not learning, they're not growing… not moving toward excellence."
  ~ *Denis Waitley* (author, keynote speaker and productivity consultant)
- "Don't fear failure so much that you refuse to try new things. The saddest summary of life contains three descriptions: could have, might have, and should have."
  ~ *Louis E. Boone* (academic author)
- "Be who you are and say what you feel because those who mind don't matter and those who matter don't mind."
  ~ *Dr. Seuss* (writer and cartoonist)

Real-World Application Check-in:

- Ask participants to share observations and thoughts.

II. Resiliency/Reframing

a. Large Group Discussion: What is resiliency?

Resiliency is…

- The ability to adapt well to stress, adversity, trauma, or tragedy
- The ability to recover from depression or discouragement. It means bouncing back from difficult experiences

Resiliency is not…

- A quality that some people possess and others do not
- Ignoring feelings of sadness or loss
- Always being strong and not asking for support
- Emotionally distant, cold or unfeeling

From Empower Your Future, Part I

b. Resiliency Strategies/Building Confidence

Hand out "The Cup is Half Full." Read through the confidence building suggestions together. Divide students into small groups (2-3 people) and have them work together to reframe the "put down" self talk. When people are finished, come together as a large group and discuss the "lift up" self talk options.

III. Coping Skills/Strategies

- Hand out "Identifying Triggers and Positive Responses to Triggers" worksheet. Ask participants to identify their triggers and the positive responses they could use. Discuss the importance of being able to identify your triggers and strategies to respond effectively to these challenges.
- Hand out "Overcoming Obstacles." Ask participants to complete the worksheet. Encourage them to think about past obstacles they have overcome and what strategies/skills helped them in those situations. Once students have finished, pair them up to discuss what they have written. After a few minutes, bring the large group together to discuss the identified obstacles.
- Support Strategies Activity
  - Identify one obstacle you don't mind sharing with the group.
  - Write it at the top of the paper — along with one strategy you can use to overcome the obstacle.
  - Pass your paper to the left; you will now have someone else's obstacle in front of you.
  - Think of a different strategy to overcome the obstacle and write it in the next box.
  - Pass the paper to the left and continue until you get your paper back.
  - Read through the new suggested strategies. Think about which ones you might be able to use.
  - Share some thoughts on this activity. How did it feel to share an obstacle and get support/suggestions from others? How did it feel to share suggestions? What new strategies would you be willing to try?

IV. Letter to Self

Write a letter to yourself that we will give/send back to you in the future. Think about your possible self, your box, your goals, etc. Be positive — focus on your strengths and what you will accomplish. After participants finish their letter, have them seal the envelope and sign over the seal so they know that no one will read their letter.

V. Training Evaluation

Please provide honest feedback on the training program.

V. What's Next

Explanation of what is to come (depends on program).

VII. Acknowledgements

- Kudos — acknowledge each participant for something they did in the program or for who they are as a person by recognizing them publicly and giving them Kudos (bar).
- Awards — create awards for each participant to acknowledge who they are, what they did in the program, a special contribution they made to the group, etc.
- Tap the shoulder activity — (not for every group — might make people uncomfortable because participants are asked to close their eyes).
  - Arrange the room so all of the participants are sitting in a circle facing out.
  - Explain the activity — this is a chance to acknowledge people anonymously.
  - Everyone will sit in their chairs with their eyes closed, or a hand over their eyes so they cannot see.
  - The facilitator will tap a couple of people on the shoulder to invite them to come into the middle of the circle. Everyone will get a chance, but 2-3 people at a time.
  - When you are invited into the middle of the circle, you will have a chance to acknowledge others in the group by gently tapping people on the shoulder when the facilitator reads different statements. For example, if the facilitator says 'makes you smile', you would gently tap the shoulder of one or more people (as many people as fit this category for you) sitting down who make you smile.
  - After a number of statements, the facilitator will ask you to sit back down and tap new people to come into the circle.
  - Make sure you only come into the circle when the facilitator taps you. The facilitator will let you know when he/she is doing the tapping.
  - Sample statements:

    GENTLY tap the shoulder of someone who:

    1. you would like to work with more
    2. you don't think gets recognized enough for all of their hard work
    3. you look up to
    4. is a good listener
    5. has supported you at work
    6. you would like to thank for something
    7. has helped you to work on bettering yourself
    8. you admire
    9. you would want to take a road trip with
    10. makes you laugh
    11. has a positive attitude
    12. you would seek out for advice
    13. you trust
    14. has inner strength
    15. helps you think about things in a different way
    16. works well with different people
    17. is flexible
    18. is very motivated
    19. you would like to be more like
    20. really seems to enjoy coming to work every day
    21. is effective and productive at work
    22. you look up to
    23. is someone you look forward to seeing at work
    24. you seldom hear complaining
    25. is courageous
    26. is a true leader
    27. is consistent
    28. has fun
    29. never gives up
    30. inspires you

Please feel free to add your own statements that fit your team/group and take away the ones that don't fit.

Make sure you are aware of how people are tapping each other on the shoulder and also who is getting tapped.

If someone is not getting tapped much (or at all), it makes sense to participate as you read and tap them for the statements you agree with. This activity usually leaves people feeling good — but if someone does not get tapped, it can leave them feeling really bad, which is not the goal.

Overcoming Obstacles

Name: Date:

What obstacles do you think you will face over the next 6 months?:

1. **Moving forward with your education?**

2. **Maintaining positive behavior?**

3. **Getting along with others?**

4. **Maintaining a positive attitude?**

OK... so what are going to do about these obstacles? Pick 2 from what you listed above and fill out the charts below to describe what YOU will do to overcome these obstacles.

Obstacle #1

What PERSONAL STRENGTHS will you count on?	What "self talk" will you use? [Positive belief statements] [Affirmations]	How can you REFRAME things?

Obstacle #2

What PERSONAL STRENGTHS will you count on?	What "self talk" will you use? [Positive belief statements] [Affirmations]	How can you REFRAME things?

From Empower Your Future, Part I

Identifying Triggers and Positive Responses to Triggers

Triggers: Events that cause me to react in a negative way/lose control

Identify your triggers by circling from the list or writing them in below

1. Other people minding my business
2. Someone blaming me for something I didn't do
3. Working hard and being told it is not enough
4. People talking to me disrespectfully
5. Someone not listening to what I have to say
6. When someone gets something that I don't
7. People laughing at me
8. Feeling excluded or rejected
9. Feeling like I am being treated unfairly
10. Being forced to follow rules
11. Being told 'no' especially for no apparent reason
12. People calling me names
13. People treating me disrespectfully
14. Feeling like I can't do anything right
15. People threatening me with consequences
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____
20. _____

Positive Responses to 'triggers'

Identify the responses you could use by circling from the list or writing them in below

1. Take a deep breath
2. Count to ten
3. Think about the different options you have
4. Picture everything working out
5. Use positive self-talk
6. Exercise
7. Talk to someone you trust
8. Walk away
9. Listen to music
10. Read
11. Write
12. Play a game
13. Do something fun
14. Pray
15. Take a hot bath or shower
16. Help someone else
17. Smile and/or laugh
18. Focus on the positives
19. Tell yourself that you can deal with this; you are resilient
20. Ask for help
21. _____
22. _____
23. _____
24. _____
25. _____

The Cup Is Half Full

Focus on the Positive

It takes confidence to move ahead. Gaining confidence (or losing confidence) goes on constantly through your whole life. It's not an all or nothing characteristic. People have confidence to varying degrees.

Developing confidence isn't as hard as you might think; there are skills you can practice. BUT you have to practice, practice, practice until it becomes a habit to greet self-doubt with self-confidence. Here are 7 suggestions.

1. **Catch yourself doing something right.**

   In your mind, make a list of your strengths. Think about what you can do. Focus on using your strengths and improving your weaknesses, not hiding your weaknesses. Most people aren't very good at hiding their weaknesses, at least not for very long. Take a look around; do you know other people's weaknesses?

2. **Talk positively to yourself.**

   If you talked to your friends the way you talk to yourself, how many friends would you have? If the answer is not many, you need to change your self-talk.

   You — and you alone — can control what your mind accepts or rejects. Every day you face a barrage of negative influences. You can replace those negative self-defeating thoughts with positive, self-fulfilling thoughts.

3. **Try something new**

   Suggestions:

   - Try a new activity that you think looks fun
   - Seek out ideas from people, places, things new to you
   - Get to know a variety of people and enjoy their unique qualities
   - Travel to a place about which you're curious

4. **Say it like you mean it**

   Statements like "I guess," "I'm sorry, but," "I might be wrong, but" just don't cut it. If you don't sound convinced of what you're saying, how can anyone else? Be Assertive. (State your idea, feeling, or opinion clearly and with respect.)

5. **Set goals and take action**

   Where would you like to be next year? In five years? It's easy to find excuses or put things off. Energy generates energy. Keep moving.

6. **Play the part**

   Look at people you admire. Name one. Look at successful people. Name one. How do they dress and behave? Do the same yourself. Look people in the eye, shake hands firmly, and speak distinctly, dress neatly. When you act confident, you really will feel more confident.

7. **Dream**

   Dreams aren't a waste of time. Start with a vision (a picture in your mind) of who you are and who you want to become. Write or draw this picture. Use details. Close your eyes and picture it. Keep the picture in a safe place. Look at it; change it. Picture it in your mind when you stop and think.

Practice

Be your strongest supporter and most loyal ally.
Change the "put down" Self talk to "lift up" Self talk. At least 2 lift ups

He's so lucky, things never work out like that for me.	**1.** **2.**
It's too early. I'm too young.	**1.** **2.**
It's too late. I'm too old.	**1.** **2.**
I do all the work, but never get any credit.	**1.** **2.**
I'll ignore the problem and hope no one notices.	**1.** **2.**
If I get caught, I'll manipulate my way out of it.	**1.** **2.**
It's not fair.	**1.** **2.**
I'll lie about it, no one will know.	**1.** **2.**
I'm a perfectionist, if I can't do it exactly right, I'm not going to do it at all.	**1.** **2.**
If I fail, I'll be embarrassed.	**1.** **2.**

Merging Two Worlds 2003, Chapter 3 Lesson 9